

SARANG GUPTA

SWISH & SNIFF Whisky tasting events organised by (clockwise from left) The Dram Club; Single Malt Amateur Club; and All Things Nice



and connoisseurs to share their single malt experiences and information. Meanwhile, in Kolkata, The Calcutta Malt and Spirits Club organises monthly sessions for its members to discuss three malts from different regions of Scotland. Though all four clubs offer free membership, individual events are often ticketed, with prices ranging from Rs 2,000 to Rs 7,000.

"We do exclusive bottlings and curate whisky tours as well. We are the only club in India with exclusive bottlings for members based on their palate preferences", says Harsha Thimmaiah, partner at Single Malt Amateur Club. Other clubs are also trying hard to exceed the tasting brief. In February 2020, The Dram Club hosted the India leg of the 20-year-old Speyside Whisky Festival, while All Things Nice has organised its own high-profile events, once bringing the legendary whisky expert Jim Murray to India. It also educates on scotch whisky through its exclusive affiliation with the Edinburgh Whisky Academy in Scotland.

The membership profile of these clubs reflects the changing face of the Indian whisky consumer. "Right from the beginning, women comprised about 25 per cent of our members and this number has steadily grown to 40 per cent. Also, over the past two years, we have seen many whisky and spirits enthusiasts in the 25-35 age group join our events and tastings. Initially, it was mostly people 35 years and above," says Sharma. All we can say is "*Slàinte Mhath*" (good health in Gaelic, pronounced Slanj-a-va). ■

–Prachi Joshi



WHISKY SAMBA
Gurugram

Whisky Samba offers 'whisky flights' or samplers, by region, as well as flavour profiles, so you can experiment with different styles of whisky.

FRESH OFF THE CASK

Best new Indian whiskies

INDRI

Named after the distillery's location below the Himalayan foothills, Indri is a delightfully layered and rich whisky with hints of black tea and caramelised pineapple. Gentle spice and nutty flavours lead to a subtle yet long finish.



KAMET

Inspired by one of the highest peaks in India, Kamet is a premium single malt distilled from the indigenous six-row barley. It is matured in a combination of ex-bourbon, ex-wine, and ex-sherry casks, giving it oaky, spice-forward notes and a complex nutty finish.



MITHUNA BY PAUL JOHN

A nuanced and intense Indian single malt, Paul John's Mithuna has been matured in American virgin oak casks and finished in ex-bourbon casks. On the nose, you have liquorice, honey and vanilla, with flavours of orange peel and dark cocoa tones.

